

European diesel release may be last offramp to avoid US export curb

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【メール原文】

Europe's response to a US request to release 120 million barrels of diesel is the key signpost for US export curbs.|||||||

Quick take

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What Happened

The US has asked European countries to release about 120 million barrels of diesel from emergency stocks over six months or face US diesel export restrictions. EU governments are seeking a common position, while Chinese refiners have suspended October fuel exports, Russia has extended its diesel export ban, and diesel exports from the Gulf are only at around half of prewar levels.

Our Take

European diesel release likely necessary to avoid US export curbs. If Europe does not act to release stockpiles by the middle of next week, and US retail prices reverse their recent declines, then we would revise our current odds of a US refined products export restriction upward (currently 40%). If European leaders appear unwilling to release stocks or move to release only a portion of the volume requested following a reported meeting tomorrow morning, the US would weigh a partial restriction to cap US exports nearer to prewar volumes.

The US is asking Europe to release 120 million barrels over 180 days, or 670,000 barrels per day (bpd), which roughly matches the 500,000-600,000 bpd we expect from fully imposed restrictions (see: [What to watch on diesel export restriction odds](#) , 30 September 2026). Our 60% basecase of no US diesel export restrictions by early October assumes falling diesel prices and looser global supply: while retail prices have fallen 10 cents from the peak of \$6.5/gallon, futures prices have ticked back up and the global supply picture looks increasingly tight. New Chinese blocks on fuel export will exacerbate supply issues.

Europe would have room to deliver the release and has more to lose from a US export ban. EU diesel stocks stand at about 350 million barrels, or 75 days of consumption, about three times the US's 105 million barrels and 26 days (see chart above). The US request equals about a third of EU stocks, or 25 days of EU demand. Europe has an incentive to find a compromise that avoids US export restrictions, as it would be hit hard by any further price spike: diesel and gasoil account for 43% of EU oil demand, against 20% in the US, and the US supplied about a third of the EU's diesel imports from outside the

bloc this year.

Global diesel supply will stay tight into early winter. Russian and Chinese export bans and reduced Gulf supply have taken about 1.6 million bpd of diesel exports off the market, or almost 6% of global demand (see table below). Russia's seaborne exports collapsed to about 150,000 bpd in July and August, from 800,000 bpd in the previous 12 months. The diesel-Brent crack spread and crude tanker rates have hit records (see charts below). The requested EU release would offset only about 40% of the shortfall; a full US export ban would nearly double it, though we expect any US restriction to affect about 500,000 bpd.

Midterm politics will keep export curbs in play if diesel prices stay near records. Five weeks before the midterms, retail diesel is \$6.4 per gallon, near its record and well above its 2022 peak, and has nearly doubled from prewar lows in several key Senate battleground states (see charts below).

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